



16GB OnePlus One

A 16GB variant of the popular OnePlus One smartphone is now available on Indian shores for ₹18,999 <http://dgit.in/OnePlus16>



Bluetooth buttons

If you're someone who loves physical buttons, the Satechi bluetooth buttons are for you. <http://dgit.in/BSatechi>

Make your own brochures and posters using Scribus

Learn to print a basic poster using desktop publishing application, Scribus

Varad Choudhari

abbijit.dey@digit.in

'Scribus' is a great application for introducing newbies to desktop publishing. Also, why spend so much money on InDesign or Quark when a perfectly viable open source alternative is available in the form of Scribus? This free and open source program is available across all major platforms including Windows, Mac and Linux. You can download Scribus from <http://wiki.scribus.net/canvas/Download> and start making your posters and brochures in no time at all. Let's get started with this workshop by familiarising you with this amazingly simple application.

Understanding the basics

Let's first look at the Scribus interface and quickly set the sensible, default settings. Whenever you open Scribus, you'll be asked to choose the document layout, select the page size and set the margin. In additional settings, you can set number of pages and default measurement unit.

The default measurement is in points (pt). This system is used by the program internally to set the distances. However, we won't recommend using points as it might not be the perfect unit to start with.

Various document layouts are offered by Scribus. These include 'single page', 'double-sided', '3-fold' and '4-fold' layouts. While single page and double-sided layouts are self-explanatory, 3-fold and 4-fold layouts let you create 3-fold and 4-fold brochures. Note that the brochure layouts don't print all the folds on the same side of the page, so if you want to do that, use single page layout.

On selecting the layout, you'll be taken to the main document. The main interface is simple and easy to understand. Right at

the top, you have the title bar followed by the main toolbar. There's only one toolbar with all the basic and necessary tools, which include the file management options (new, open, save), editing options (cut, copy and paste) and options to add object(s) to the document (text, image, line, shapes etc).

The document area shows the page in the layout that you'd previously selected, displayed along with the margins.



Change the grid settings for easy alignment of the elements on the page

At the bottom, there are options to manage the document area. You can change the measurement unit from here as well. Beside this is the image preview setting. You can choose from High, Normal and Low as the preview quality of the images to be displayed on your screen. There's a Zoom in and Zoom out button and an option to manually enter the zoom amount. If you have more than one page in the document, you can use the Next page and Previous page buttons. Additionally, there's a toggle button for color management and a Preview mode at the bottom right.

Now that you've been introduced to the user interface, let's quickly make a simple poster.

Making a simple poster

Open Scribus and select 'Single page' document layout with A4 page size and millimeters as the default unit. Hit 'OK' and you'll be taken to the main document. On this page, we'll design our poster. By default, grids are turned off. We recommend turning them on for proper alignment. To do this, navigate to View > Show Grids. Now, if you look closely, the grid doesn't

properly occupy the whole page. You need to tweak some basic grid settings to correct this issue. Go to File > Document Setup (or Preferences) > Guides and change the major grid spacing to '30 mm' and minor grid spacing to '6 mm'. Hit 'Apply' to apply the changes to the document.

We've chosen 30 mm and 6 mm because the A4 page is 210 mm wide. Therefore, there will be exactly seven grid boxes with five small boxes inside it.

Now navigate to PDF Export > Color and change 'Output Intended' to 'Printer' and tick the 'Convert spot colors to processed colors' option. These tweaks are necessary since our output will be printed. Spot colors (CMYK) are used by press printers, whereas desktop printers use processed colors (RGB). This simple poster will print as intended on a desktop printer, so it's recommended that you convert the spot colors to processed colors and hit 'Apply'.

You can now start making a simple poster. Begin by defining areas on the